

FILM DOSSIER: IRON MAN 3

Phase 2 · Film #1 (Saga Film #9)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	9 of 29 (Phase 2, Film #1)
Phase	Phase 2 (2013–2015)
Real title	<i>IRON MAN 3</i>
Decoy / codename title	" <i>HIBERNATION</i> "
Release date	Friday, May 3, 2013
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Shane Black
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 162 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + biotech techno-thriller / body horror

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK (Iron Man, film 3 of the franchise)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Marc-Anthony Bullock	31
Pepper Potts	Tayia Boyd	31
James Rhodes / War Machine	Don Cheadle	48
The Mandarin	Tony Leung	50
Dr. Maya Hansen	Rebecca Hall	31 (<i>her birthday is release day</i>)
Aldrich Killian	Guy Pearce	45
Mallen	James Badge Dale (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	35
Happy Hogan	Jon Favreau	46
Bruce Banner (<i>mid-credit cameo</i>)	Amond Baker	31
Agent Jasper Sitwell	Maximiliano Hernández	39
Mistress Death (<i>at Tony's cocoon</i>)	Aubrey Plaza	28
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a beauty-pageant judge in Austin</i>)	Stan Lee	90

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>Iron Man: Extremis</i> , <i>Iron Man</i> vol. 4 #1–6 (2005–06), Warren Ellis & Adi Granov: Maya Hansen, Aldrich Killian, Mallen , and Tony injecting himself with Extremis . " <i>Haunted</i> ", <i>Iron Man: Director of S.H.I.E.L.D.</i> #29–32 (2008), Stuart Moore & Carlos Pacheco: the Mandarin forces Maya Hansen to perfect Extremis for a worldwide release.
Supporting comics	<i>Iron Man</i> #281–284 (1992): Tony builds the " Variable Threat Response Battle Suit ," and Rhodey takes it as War Machine · <i>Iron Man</i> vol. 5 #23–28 (2014), Kieron Gillen: after the Mandarin's defeat, the ten rings leave to seek new bearers
Nerf check	✓ Mallen beats Iron Man badly in their first fight, exactly as in <i>Extremis</i> #3. Tony wins the rematch because Extremis makes him stronger than ever , not because Mallen got weaker.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96%. <i>Extremis</i> is adapted almost beat for beat, joined to the Mandarin's Extremis scheme from "Haunted" (2008).

Straight from the page:

- **Extremis** is a nanotech **super-soldier virus** from **Futurepharm** in **Austin, Texas**. It rewrites the body's "repair center" and needs a **cocoon stage** (*Extremis* #1).
- **Aldrich Killian** leaks Extremis and **takes his own life** (#1). This happens off-screen for PG-13.
- **Mallen**, a domestic extremist, is injected with it and gains **super strength, regeneration, and fire breath**. He massacres an FBI convoy in **Houston** (#1–2).
- **Mallen beats Iron Man badly** (#3).
- **Tony, near death, has Maya Hansen inject him with Extremis**. He goes into a **cocoon**. He comes out able to **store the armor's undersheath inside his hollow bones, control the armor with his mind, and connect directly to every network and satellite on Earth** (#4–5).
- **The Mandarin coerces Maya into perfecting Extremis** so he can release it worldwide ("Haunted").
- **Tony builds the War Machine armor and Rhodey takes it** (*Iron Man* #281–284).
- **When the Mandarin falls, the rings leave to seek new hosts** (vol. 5 #28).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Mandarin's Extremis plot (2008) is combined with *Extremis* (2005) | It gives the Iron Man trilogy one villain throughout. The Mandarin carries through all three films. |

| War Machine (1992) arrives in the Extremis-era film | Rhodey has earned his own armor since "Next time, baby" in 2008. |

| Maya Hansen's fate | She survives the film. Her 616 death (2008) is held back, and **she's arrested for her part in the Extremis program**. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Tony Stark (Extremis)	The undersheath stored in his bones; mental control of the armor; direct wireless connection to phones, networks and satellites; boosted healing and reflexes (<i>Extremis</i> #4–5)	All of it. He calls the armor by thought, reads a city's CCTV grid in a second, takes over a missile's guidance, and his wounds close within hours.	Later Bleeding Edge / nanotech armor (616, 2008–09, later films)	✓ 100%
Iron Man (Model 29 / Extremis armor)	A thinner, stronger, faster armor, run through Extremis	Supersonic flight, repulsors, uni-beam, catching a falling 747 fuselage	–	✓ 100%
War Machine	Heavily armed Iron Man variant: shoulder-mounted cannon, missiles, flamethrowers, gauntlet guns (<i>Iron Man</i> #281)	All of it; he holds a bridge against thirty Extremis soldiers	–	✓ 100%
Mallen	Extremis super strength, near-instant regeneration, fire breath, electrical projection (<i>Extremis</i> #1–5)	All of it. Round one, he nearly kills Iron Man.	–	✓ 100%
The Mandarin	All ten Makluan rings; master martial artist; genius	All ten rings again, plus a Makluan-built ring-powered battle armor in the finale	–	✓ 100%. He loses to Extremis-boosted Tony plus War Machine.
Extremis soldiers	Super strength, regeneration, heat projection; unstable (they can explode)	The Mandarin's army	–	✓ 100%
Maya Hansen	Genius biochemist (<i>Extremis</i> #1)	Designs Extremis; saves Tony's life	–	✓ 100%
Pepper Potts	Executive; courageous	Runs Stark Industries through the crisis and hides Maya's data	Rescue armor (616, 2009, later films)	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	After saving the world, Tony Stark can't stop building armor. Then a virus that makes men into weapons shows up, and it's connected to the Mandarin, and Tony has to put the armor inside himself to survive.
Theme	The armor was always inside him. Iron Man isn't the suit. It's the man.
Villain / antagonist	The Mandarin (main); Mallen (his Extremis enforcer); Aldrich Killian (the leak that starts it)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE LEAK

- **Monday, January 7, 2013.** Eight months after *The Avengers*, Tony is paying for the team, running Stark Industries, and not sleeping. He's building armor after armor in the Avengers Mansion basement. He's **stayed sober**, and Pepper sees the building for what it is: a new bottle.
- In **Austin, Texas**, **Dr. Maya Hansen**, an old acquaintance of Tony's, calls in a panic. Her partner **Aldrich Killian** has **leaked Extremis** and **taken his own life**.
- **Houston**: a man named **Mallen**, injected with Extremis, **wipes out an FBI convoy** with fire and bare hands.

ACT TWO: THE COCOON

- Iron Man goes after Mallen, and Mallen **almost kills him**. The armor is shredded, Tony's organs are failing, and Rhodey drags him out.
- Maya offers the one thing that could save him: **Extremis**.
- Tony agrees. He goes into the **cocoon**.
- In the dark, his heart stops. Only the audience sees **the hooded woman** standing at the foot of the bed. **She looks at Tony, then turns away**. He wakes.
- **Tony comes out of the cocoon changed**. He can think the armor onto his body and hear every phone in Texas. In the **rematch** in downtown Houston, he takes Mallen apart.
- Maya's funding trail leads to **the Mandarin**. He forced her to make Extremis stable for **mass release**.

ACT THREE: WAR MACHINE

- The Mandarin plans to spread an aerosol form of Extremis from his Makluan starship over **Beijing, Mumbai, Lagos and New York**, and whoever survives will be his army.
- Tony gives Rhodey the **Variable Threat Response Battle Suit**. Rhodey: *"Took you long enough."* **War Machine** is born.
- **The Valley of Spirits**. Tony, in the Extremis armor, and War Machine fight through the Mandarin's Extremis soldiers.
- **Iron Man vs. the Mandarin** in his ring-powered armor. All ten rings against a man who runs his armor by thought. Tony uses **Extremis to overload the starship's reactor through the Mandarin's own link to it**.
- The Mandarin falls into the reactor core. **His body is never found**.

- Maya is arrested. At Avengers Mansion, Tony stands in the basement full of armors, then shuts the lights off and goes upstairs to Pepper.
- Final line, voiceover: *"They can take the suits. They can't take the armor. I am Iron Man."*

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, January 7, 2013 → Saturday, April 6, 2013. The mid-credit and post-credit scenes are in April 2013 .
Where it's set	Avengers Mansion, NYC · Futurepharm, Austin, Texas · Houston · Stark Industries, Long Island · the Valley of Spirits, China (filmed in Texas and in Zhangjiajie, Hunan)
Relative to other films	Eight months after <i>The Avengers</i>. Tony mentions that "Cap's out running the team this month," and that "Big Green hasn't called."

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Extremis:** Tony is permanently changed and fused with his technology.
- **War Machine:** Rhodey's own armor.
- **The end of the Mandarin trilogy (2008–2013),** and the rings loose in the world.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Avengers are an institution now	The Mansion, Jarvis running a staff, a monitor duty rotation board: <i>CAP · THOR · WASP · GIANT-MAN · IRON MAN</i>	<i>Avengers 2</i>
Extremis in the world	Doses are missing from Futurepharm's inventory	Phase 2–3
The Hulk	The mid-credit scene	The Hulk's Phase 2 film
The Cosmic Cube	Sitwell's briefing: A.I.M. is buying Futurepharm's Extremis stock <i>"to stabilize something they lost"</i>	Phase 2

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Death turns away from Tony	The cocoon flatline	Tony has now seen Death twice (Yinsen and himself). She keeps passing him by.
The Elders of the Universe	In the Mandarin's starship, the Makluan star-charts glow: six points of light, each beside a different figure. The Mandarin says, <i>"The jewels are held by the Elders of the Universe... and the Titan has begun to take them."</i>	The Thanos Quest has started. On 616, Thanos takes the Gems from the Elders (<i>The Thanos Quest</i> #1–2, 1990).
The rings	The post-credit scene	The rings go looking for new bearers.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	 "THERAPY." Avengers Mansion. Tony has spent the whole night telling Bruce Banner about Extremis, the cocoon, the Mandarin, all of it. He finally turns around. Bruce is asleep in the armchair. TONY: <i>"...Seriously?"</i> BRUCE (waking): <i>"I'm a nuclear physicist, Tony. I'm not that kind of doctor."</i> (beat) BRUCE: <i>"Also, I've been awake for four days. The other guy doesn't sleep."</i>
Post-credit scene	 "TEN." The ruins of the Makluan starship in the Valley of Spirits, at night. In the rubble of the reactor core, the Mandarin's ten rings lie in the ash. One by one they glow, rise, and fly off in ten directions across the world. The last one heads straight up, toward the stars. CUT TO BLACK. "IRON MAN WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "NAP TIME." Post-credit: "JEWELRY BOX II."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline